

doc-supper-spiritual-communion

Affirms · Sacraments › Lord's Supper · doctrine · divided_lineages · confidence: medium

Statement under examination

The Lord's Supper includes spiritual communion with the risen Christ by faith; believers feed on Christ spiritually, distinguishing the position from bare Zwinglian memorialism.

Rationale

Pauline lexical pattern. In 1 Cor 10:16 the cup and bread are explicitly called a *koinonia* G2842 (participation, fellowship, joint-share) in the blood and body of Christ, with the rhetorical questions *ou koinonia estin tou haimatos tou Christou* G2842 G129 G5547 and *ou koinonia tou somatos tou Christou estin* G2842 G4983 G5547 expecting an affirmative answer. In 1 Cor 10:17 the partaking (*metechomen* G3348) of the one bread (*heis artos* G740) establishes the corporate one-body reality. In 1 Cor 11:29 the eater who fails to discern (*diakrinon* G1252) the body (*soma* G4983) eats judgment to himself, language stronger than what a purely memorial-symbolic act would naturally bear. In John 6:54-58 Jesus uses the strong verb *trogo* G5176 (gnaw, chew, durative-realistic eating, distinct from the more general *phago*) of feeding on himself for life. In 1 Cor 10:1-4 the OT typology names Christ as the *pneumatike petra* G4152 G4073 (spiritual rock) from which the fathers drank, framing eucharistic participation within a substantive spiritual-feeding pattern. The lexical pattern is canonical, not single-passage. John 6:63 (*to pneuma estin to zoopoion he sarx ouk ophelei ouden* G4151 G2227 G4561 G5623, the Spirit is the life-giver, the flesh profits nothing) disciplines the reading: the feeding is real but spiritual, by faith through the Spirit, not carnal or mechanical. Christ is the substance encountered in the supper; the mode is spiritual, the means is faith, the agent is the Holy Spirit. This rules out both bare memorialism (Spirit-and-faith feeding is more than mental recollection) and physicalist mechanisms (the flesh profits nothing without the Spirit). The verdict therefore affirms a real spiritual communion with Christ in the supper without specifying transubstantiation, consubstantiation, or sacramental-union as the canonical mode.

Reasoning

The Bible teaches that the Lord's Supper is more than a mental memory of Jesus. Something real happens between Christ and the believer when they eat the bread and drink the cup in faith. The strongest reason for this is the way Paul talks about it in 1 Corinthians 10:16. He asks, the cup of blessing that we bless, is it not a participation in the blood of Christ. The bread that we break, is it not a participation in the body of Christ. The word he uses for participation is the same word used elsewhere for the deep partnership of believers with God and with each other. He expects the answer yes. In 1 Corinthians 10:17 he goes further and says that because there is one bread, we who are many are one body, because we all partake of the one bread. Eating is real participation in the body of Christ. In 1 Corinthians 11:29 he warns that someone who eats without discerning the body eats judgment on himself. This warning is stronger than what a purely symbolic ceremony would carry. In John 6:54 to 58 Jesus uses a strong word for eating, a word that means to gnaw or chew, and says whoever feeds on me will live because of me. There is a complicating text in John 6:63. Right after the strong eating language Jesus says, the Spirit gives life. The flesh is of no help at all. The words I have spoken to you are spirit and life. Critics of any real-presence reading point to this verse to argue the supper is only a memory aid. The verdict handles the tension this way. John 6:63 does not cancel the eating language. It tells the reader the mode is spiritual, not carnal. The communion is real, but the agent is the Holy Spirit and the instrument is faith. The eating is not mechanical chewing on flesh. It is the believer feeding on Christ spiritually as the Spirit unites them to him. There is also the simple remembrance language. In 1 Corinthians 11:24 to 26 Jesus says do this in remembrance of me, and Paul says as often as you eat this bread and drink the cup, you proclaim the

Lord's death until he comes. The supper IS a memorial. It is also more than a memorial. Both layers stand together in the same Pauline texts.

Denominational landscape

Christian lineages have agreed for almost the entire history of the church that the Lord's Supper involves some real spiritual communion with Christ, and disagreed only about the mode. Patristic writers from the second century onward use language of body and blood for the bread and wine without scholastic specification. Justin Martyr in the First Apology chapter 66 calls the eucharist the flesh and blood of Jesus who was made flesh. The Roman Catholic teaching, articulated in the Catechism paragraphs 1373 to 1381, holds transubstantiation, that the substance of the bread and wine becomes the body and blood of Christ while the appearances remain. The Eastern Orthodox reading affirms the real body and blood as a mystery, without scholastic explanation. The Lutheran reading in the Augsburg Confession Article X holds sacramental union, that the body and blood are truly present in, with, and under the bread and wine. The Anglican reading in Article 28 of the 39 Articles affirms that the body of Christ is given, taken, and eaten only after a heavenly and spiritual manner, and the means of receiving is faith. The Methodist Article XVIII repeats this Anglican language almost verbatim, locating the receiving in a heavenly and spiritual manner by faith. The Reformed reading following Calvin holds spiritual-real-presence, that the believer truly feeds on Christ by faith through the Holy Spirit, with Christ bodily in heaven and the Spirit uniting believer to Christ across the distance. This is the classical Westminster and Belgic reading. The strict Zwinglian-memorialist reading, that the elements are only symbols and the act is only remembrance, is the minority position historically. It is held by many Baptists, Plymouth Brethren, some non-denominational congregations, and some Pentecostal traditions. The Assemblies of God position has historically leaned memorialist but with growing acknowledgment of spiritual presence in practice. The Anabaptist Schleithem Confession of 1527 names the supper as a remembrance of the broken body and shed blood. Public-record carriers of total denial of any spiritual reality in the supper, treating it as a purely civic or ethical exercise, are rare and are usually associated with rationalist or theologically liberal lineages rather than confessing Christian ones. The verdict that some real spiritual communion attends the supper is the broad Christian consensus across patristic, Catholic, Orthodox, Lutheran, Anglican, Reformed, and Methodist lineages. The strict-memorialist position is a minority Protestant view from the Zwinglian Reformation and downstream Free Church traditions.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	No
Cult marker if denied	No
Would visit if otherwise	Yes
Would participate if otherwise	Yes
Would serve if otherwise	Yes
Would be member if otherwise	Yes
Would let children be taught otherwise	Yes
Would marry if held otherwise	Yes
Would publicly correct if otherwise	No

Notes

Two questions sit inside the proposition. (1) Is the Lord's Supper more than a bare memorial, involving some real spiritual communion with the risen Christ? Yes, canonically established by the lexical pattern of koinonia G2842 in 1 Cor 10:16, the metechomen G3348 / one-body language of 1 Cor 10:17, the discerning-the-body discipline of 1 Cor 11:27-29, the trogo G5176 feeding of John 6:54-58, and the spiritual-rock typology of 1 Cor 10:1-4. (2) What is the MODE of the real communion (transubstantiation, consubstantiation, sacramental union, spiritual-real-presence by faith, virtualism)? This is where lineages diverge. The Roman Catholic reading is transubstantiation (the substance of bread and wine becomes the body and blood, accidents remaining). The Eastern Orthodox reading is a real mystery, the substance affirmed without scholastic specification. The Lutheran reading is sacramental union (the body and blood are truly present in, with, and under the bread and wine). The Anglican reading in Article 28 is real spiritual presence received by faith. The Reformed reading following Calvin is spiritual-real-presence: the believer truly feeds on Christ by faith through the Holy Spirit, Christ being bodily in heaven. The Methodist reading following the 39 Articles affirms heavenly and spiritual manner of receiving. The historic Brethren and many Baptist readings have leaned Zwinglian-memorialist, treating the elements as symbols and the act as remembrance. The cult-marker bar is NOT met. This is in-house Christian disagreement about sacramental theology, not about the gospel boundary or a Trinitarian or Christological core. Public-record carriers of denial of any spiritual reality at all are rare; even most memorialist traditions affirm some communion-with-Christ-by-faith in practice even if their formal doctrine is strict-symbolic. The Plymouth Brethren formation typically holds the memorial-symbolic view, sometimes explicitly contrasted with sacramental readings. Brethren-on-trial discipline: the historic Brethren memorialist reading is defensible at the level of the discrete event (the supper IS a remembrance, anamnesis of the Lord's death until he comes, 1 Cor 11:26), but it under-reads the koinonia G2842 / metechomen G3348 / trogo G5176 lexical pattern that names the supper as more-than-memorial. The verdict affirms the substantive-spiritual-communion reading while granting that the MODE is not canonically settled. Pastorally: a Christian holding strict memorialism still receives Christ by faith when they eat in faith, because the agent is the Spirit and the receiving instrument is faith, not the formal doctrine of the moment.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: **yes**

Neutralized form. Does the Lord's Supper involve any real spiritual communion with the risen Christ beyond bare memorial-symbolic remembrance, and if so what does the canonical lexical pattern say about the mode and means?

Notes. The original statement uses Reformed-Calvinist vocabulary (spiritual communion, feed on Christ spiritually) and explicitly names Zwinglian memorialism as the position the statement distinguishes itself from. This pre-loads a verdict against memorialism using one lineage's preferred framing. The neutralized form opens the question at the level of the canonical lexical pattern (koinonia, metechomen, trogo, anamnesis) and lets the apparatus settle the more-than-memorial question first, then notes that mode is contested. The verdict is worked from the neutralized form: the lexical pattern does establish more-than-memorial real spiritual communion, but the mode remains in-house contested. Flag stem-pre-loaded-verdict added.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, sacramental_realism, memorialist_symbolism, dispensationalism
analogia scripturae invoked

Competing lens verdicts

sacramental realism (Roman Catholic transubstantiation, Lutheran sacramental union) · **affirms:**

Reformed spiritual-real-presence (Calvin, Westminster, Belgic) · **affirms:**

Anglican / Methodist heavenly-and-spiritual-manner · **affirms:**

Zwinglian-memorialist symbolism (some Baptist, Plymouth Brethren, some non-denominational) · **denies**
(in formal doctrine) / **affirms-in-practice** (in faith-eating):

Grammatico-historical reading is decisive on the more-than-memorial verdict at the lexical level. Koinonia G2842 in 1 Cor 10:16 is the load-bearing term, and its semantic range, controlled by 1 John 1:3 and Phil 3:10, names substantive participation, not symbolic association. The verb metecho G3348 in 1 Cor 10:17 and 10:21 reinforces the substantive reading; the parallel between Lord's table and demons' table (10:21) requires both to be real participations. The verb trogo G5176 in John 6:54-58 is deliberately strong, contrasting with the more general phago. The discerning-the-body discipline in 1 Cor 11:29 is incoherent on bare memorialism. Analogia scripturae is invoked across koinonia / metecho / trogo / meno. John 6:63 disciplines the mode (spiritual, by faith, through the Spirit) but does not cancel the substantive eating. The MODE of the real communion is canonically under-determined. Transubstantiation, consubstantiation, and sacramental union read more into the texts than the lexical pattern requires. The Reformed-Anglican-Methodist spiritual-real-presence reading is the most modest position consistent with both the koinonia language and John 6:63. The strict-memorialist position cannot account for the koinonia and trogo language without straining the lexical force.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

1Cor.10.16 · **for** · genre: epistle · figures: metonymy

Key term. τὸ ποτήριον τῆς εὐλογίας ὃ εὐλογοῦμεν οὐχὶ κοινωνία ἐστὶν τοῦ αἵματος τοῦ Χριστοῦ to poterion tes eulogias ho eulougoumen ouchi koinonia estin tou haimatos tou Christou G4221 G2129 G2127 G2842 G129 G5547 (the cup of blessing which we bless, is it not a participation in the blood of Christ); τὸν ἄρτον ὃν κλῶμεν οὐχὶ κοινωνία τοῦ σώματος τοῦ Χριστοῦ ἐστὶν ton arton hon klomen ouchi koinonia tou somatos tou Christou estin G740 G2806 G2842 G4983 G5547 (the bread which we break, is it not a participation in the body of Christ)

Force. Pauline locus classicus. The rhetorical particle ouchi expects an affirmative answer. Koinonia G2842 (participation, fellowship, joint-share) is the same word used for fellowship with the Father and the Son in 1 John 1:3 and for sharing in Christ's sufferings in Phil 3:10. The genitives tou haimatos and tou somatos are objective genitives naming the thing participated in. The lexical force is stronger than mental recollection. The cup and bread are named as the means of a real joint-share in the blood and body of Christ.

1Cor.10.17 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metonymy, metaphor

Key term. ὅτι εἷς ἄρτος ἐν σῶμα οἱ πολλοὶ ἐσμεν οἱ γὰρ πάντες ἐκ τοῦ ἑνὸς ἄρτου μετέχομεν *hoti heis artos hen soma hoi polloi esmen hoi gar pantes ek tou henos artou metechomen* G1520 G740 G4983 G3348 (because there is one bread, we who are many are one body, for we all partake of the one bread)

Force. The verb *metecho* G3348 (to share, partake, have a share in) is present indicative active 1st plural, naming an ongoing participation. The corporate result (one body) flows from the joint-partaking. This text extends the *koinonia* argument: the eating is what constitutes the corporate one-body reality, not merely a sign of an already-existing reality. The eating itself is the participating.

1Cor.11.27-29 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἔνοχος ἔσται τοῦ σώματος καὶ τοῦ αἵματος τοῦ κυρίου *enochos estai tou somatos kai tou haimatos tou kyriou* G1777 G4983 G129 G2962 (he shall be guilty of the body and blood of the Lord); μὴ διακρίνων τὸ σῶμα *me diakrino to soma* G1252 G4983 (not discerning the body); κρίμα ἑαυτῷ ἐσθίει καὶ πίνει *krima heauto esthie kai pinei* G2917 (eats and drinks judgment to himself)

Force. The discipline of unworthy eating. The eater becomes *enochos* (liable, answerable, guilty) of the body and blood, language drawn from criminal-court usage. The verb *diakrino* G1252 (to discriminate, distinguish) with *to soma* names the failure to recognize what is being eaten. The judgment-eating language is stronger than what a purely-memorial reading naturally bears. Some weak and sick and asleep among them (v.30) names actual physical consequences in the assembly. The text disciplines bare memorialism by treating the eating as having real consequence in the believer's relation to the body of Christ.

1Cor.11.24-26 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. τοῦτό μου ἐστὶν τὸ σῶμα *touto mou estin to soma* G4983 (this is my body); εἰς τὴν ἐμὴν ἀνάμνησιν *eis ten emen anamnesin* G364 (in remembrance of me); τὸν θάνατον τοῦ κυρίου καταγγέλλετε *ton thanaton tou kyriou katangellete* G2605 G2288 (you proclaim the Lord's death)

Force. Complicating canonical text. The supper IS named *anamnesis* (remembrance), and the eating IS a proclamation (*katangellete*, present indicative active 2nd plural) of the Lord's death until he comes. This warrants memorial-language in the doctrine of the supper. It does NOT exhaust the supper to remembrance alone; it sits alongside the *koinonia* and *metecho* language of chapter 10 and the judgment-eating language of 11:29. The doctrine of the supper is multi-layered in the same letter: memorial AND participation AND proclamation AND covenant.

John.6.54-56 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key term. ὁ τρώγων μου τὴν σάρκα καὶ πίνων μου τὸ αἷμα *ho trogon mou ten sarka kai pinon mou to haima* G5176 G4561 G129 (the one feeding on my flesh and drinking my blood); ἔχει ζωὴν αἰώνιον *echei zoen aionion* G2222 G166 (has eternal life); ἐν ἐμοὶ μένει κάγω ἐν αὐτῷ *en emoi menei kago en auto* G3306 (abides in me and I in him)

Force. Strong-feeding language. The verb *trogo* G5176 (to gnaw, chew, durative-realistic eating, used in John 13:18 of the one eating bread who lifts up his heel against me) is deliberately stronger than the more general *phago*. The present participle *trogon* names ongoing eating, not a one-time act. The result is eternal life and mutual abiding (*menei* G3306, the same verb used in John 15 of the vine and branches). The lexical pattern frames feeding on Christ as substantive participation, not symbolic recollection. The text is contested as to whether it directly references the supper or names a broader spiritual feeding on Christ by faith, but the eucharistic resonance is undeniable in the verb choice.

John.6.63 · complicates · genre: gospel · figures: metonymy

Key term. τὸ πνεῦμά ἐστιν τὸ ζωοποιῶν ἢ σὰρξ οὐκ ὠφελεῖ οὐδέν to pneuma estin to zoopoion he sarx ouk ophelai ouden G4151 G2227 G4561 G5623 (the Spirit is the life-giver, the flesh profits nothing); τὰ ῥήματα ἃ ἐγὼ λελάληκα ὑμῖν πνεῦμά ἐστιν καὶ ζωὴ ἐστιν ta rhemata ha ego lelaleka humin pneuma estin kai zoe estin G4487 G2222 (the words I have spoken to you are spirit and they are life)

Force. Disciplining text. Jesus' own commentary on the flesh-eating language of vv.54-58. The participle zoopoion (life-giving) names the Spirit as the agent of the feeding. The flesh (sarx) profits nothing apart from the Spirit's life-giving work. This rules out a carnal-mechanical reading of eating Christ's flesh. The feeding is real but spiritual, the agent the Spirit, the receiving instrument faith. This text complicates both bare memorialism (the Spirit gives life through Christ's words) and physicalist sacramentology (the flesh profits nothing apart from the Spirit).

1Cor.10.3-4 · for · genre: epistle · figures: typology

Key term. τὸ αὐτὸ πνευματικὸν βρῶμα ἔφαγον καὶ τὸ αὐτὸ πνευματικὸν ἔπιον πόμα to auto pneumatikon broma ephagon kai to auto pneumatikon epion poma G4152 G1033 G5315 G4188 (the same spiritual food they ate and the same spiritual drink they drank); ἔπινον γὰρ ἐκ πνευματικῆς ἀκολουθούσης πέτρας ἡ δὲ πέτρα ἦν ὁ Χριστός epinon gar ek pneumatikes akolouthouses petras he de petra en ho Christos G4152 G190 G4073 G5547 (they drank from a spiritual rock that followed them, and the rock was Christ)

Force. OT typology. Paul reads the wilderness manna and water-from-the-rock as substantive spiritual participation in Christ. The adjective pneumatikon G4152 (spiritual) qualifies both broma (food) and poma (drink). The clause he petra en ho Christos identifies the OT type with Christ himself. The framing context immediately precedes the cup-and-bread argument of vv.16-17. The substantive-spiritual-feeding pattern is canonical, applied retroactively to the OT and forward to the Christian eucharist. Memorial-only reading cannot account for Paul's typological argument here.

1Cor.10.21 · for · genre: epistle · figures: parallelism

Key term. οὐ δύνασθε ποτήριον κυρίου πίνειν καὶ ποτήριον δαιμονίων ου dynasthe poterion kyriou pinein kai poterion daimonion G4221 G2962 G1140 (you cannot drink the cup of the Lord and the cup of demons); οὐ δύνασθε τραπέζης κυρίου μετέχειν καὶ τραπέζης δαιμονίων ου dynasthe trapezes kyriou metechein kai trapezes daimonion G5132 G3348 (you cannot partake of the table of the Lord and the table of demons)

Force. Direct continuation of the koinonia argument. The verb metecho G3348 (partake, share in) is used identically of the Lord's table and pagan altars. Paul's logic: eating at the pagan altar constitutes participation with demons (koinonous ton daimonion, v.20); therefore eating at the Lord's table constitutes participation with the Lord. The structural parallelism requires both sides to be substantive participations, not symbolic gestures. This complicates memorialism at the lexical level: if pagan eating is real demonic participation, Christian eating is real Christ-participation.

Luke.22.19-20 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metonymy

Key term. τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ σῶμά μου τὸ ὑπὲρ ὑμῶν διδόμενον τοῦτο ποιεῖτε εἰς τὴν ἐμὴν ἀνάμνησιν touto estin to soma mou to huper humon didomenon touto poieite eis ten emen anamnesin G4983 G364 (this is my body, given for you, do this in remembrance of me); ἡ καινὴ διαθήκη ἐν τῷ αἵματί μου he kaine diatheke en to haimati mou G2537 G1242 G129 (the new covenant in my blood)

Force. Dominical institution. The bread is named touto estin to soma mou (this is my body). The cup is named the new covenant in my blood. Both copulas are contested as to mode (identification, representation, substantive presence). The anamnesis clause warrants memorial-language. The covenant-language (kaine diatheke, drawing on Jer 31:31-34 LXX) names the supper as covenant-meal, locating it in the canonical OT covenant pattern (Exodus 24, Passover) where covenant meals were substantive participation in covenant blessing, not merely symbolic acts.

Acts.2.42 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. τῇ διδασκῇ τῶν ἀποστόλων καὶ τῇ κοινωνίᾳ τῇ κλάσει τοῦ ἄρτου te didache ton apostolon kai te koinonia te klasei tou artou G1322 G2842 G2800 G740 (the apostles' teaching and the fellowship, the breaking of bread); καὶ ταῖς προσευχαῖς kai tais proseuchais G4335 (and the prayers)

Force. Acts narrative. The early church's life is named in four marks: didache (teaching), koinonia G2842, klasis tou artou (breaking of bread), and proseuche (prayer). The verbal proximity of koinonia and breaking of bread is structurally telling: the supper is named within the koinonia pattern, not separated from it. The Pauline koinonia language in 1 Cor 10:16 picks up this Lucan thread.

1John.1.3 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἡ κοινωνία δὲ ἡ ἡμετέρα μετὰ τοῦ πατρὸς καὶ μετὰ τοῦ υἱοῦ αὐτοῦ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ he koinonia de he hemetera meta tou patros kai meta tou huiou autou Iesou Christou G2842 G3962 G5207 G2424 G5547 (our fellowship is with the Father and with his Son Jesus Christ)

Force. Lexical control on koinonia G2842. The same word Paul uses for the cup and bread participation in 1 Cor 10:16 John uses for the substantive fellowship with the Father and Son. This disciplines any reading that flattens koinonia to mere association. Koinonia in the NT names a real-relational sharing with divine persons. By lexical analogia scripturae, the koinonia of the cup and bread participates in this same family of meaning.

John.15.4-5 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key term. μέναιτε ἐν ἐμοὶ κἀγὼ ἐν ὑμῖν meinate en emoi kago en humin G3306 (abide in me and I in you); ὁ μένων ἐν ἐμοὶ κἀγὼ ἐν αὐτῷ οὗτος φέρει καρπὸν πολὺν ho menon en emoi kago en auto houtos pherei karpon polyn G3306 G2590 (the one abiding in me and I in him, this one bears much fruit)

Force. Johannine mutual-abiding pattern. The same verb meno G3306 used in John 6:56 (en emoi menei kago en auto, of the one feeding on Christ). The eating-language and the abiding-language are interlocked. Feeding on Christ is the mode of abiding; abiding is the result of feeding. This text frames the substantive spiritual communion as the broad Johannine theology, not a one-off eucharistic insertion.

Phil.3.10 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. κοινωνίαν παθημάτων αὐτοῦ koinonian pathematon autou G2842 G3804 (fellowship of his sufferings)

Force. Lexical control on koinonia G2842. Paul names the substantive participation in Christ's sufferings as koinonia. Same word as 1 Cor 10:16. Same family of meaning: real-relational joint-share. Disciplines memorial-only readings of koinonia in the eucharistic context.

2Pet.1.4 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. γένησθε θείας κοινωνοὶ φύσεως genesthe theias koinonoi physeos G2844 G2304 G5449 (you may become partakers of divine nature)

Force. Cognate-noun control. Koinonos G2844 (partaker, sharer) is the noun-form of the same root as koinonia G2842. Believers are named partakers of divine nature through the precious promises. This locates substantive participation as the canonical New Covenant reality. The eucharistic koinonia in 1 Cor 10:16 is one expression of this broader canonical pattern of substantive participation in divine reality.

Heb.10.19-22 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. ἔχοντες παρρησίαν εἰς τὴν εἴσοδον τῶν ἁγίων ἐν τῷ αἵματι Ἰησοῦ echontes parresian eis ten eisodon ton hagion en to haimati Iesou G3954 G1529 G39 G129 (having boldness to enter the holy places by the blood of Jesus); προσερχώμεθα μετὰ ἀληθινῆς καρδίας ἐν πληροφορίᾳ πίστεως proserchometha meta alethines kardias en plerophoria pisteos G4334 G4136 G4102 (let us draw near with a true heart in full assurance of faith)

Force. Hebrews provides the new-covenant access pattern. The believer draws near to God by the blood of Jesus, with full assurance of faith. The drawing-near (proserchometha) language frames worship as substantive access. The eucharistic frame is not explicit here, but the canonical pattern of access-by-blood and faith-mediated participation is the broader theological context in which the supper sits. Complicates strict-memorialist readings that detach the supper from substantive new-covenant access.

Concordance lemmas traversed

G2842, G2844, G3348, G5176, G740, G4983, G129, G5547, G4221, G2129, G2127, G2806, G364, G2605, G1252, G1777, G2917, G4561, G2222, G166, G3306, G4151, G2227, G5623, G4487, G4152, G1033, G5315, G4188, G190, G4073, G2962, G1140, G5132, G2537, G1242, G1322, G2800, G4335, G3962, G5207, G2424, G3804, G2304, G5449, G3954, G1529, G39, G4334, G4136, G4102, G2590, G1520

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Justin Martyr, First Apology chapter 66 (mid-2nd century), ccel.org · affirms · verified

“The food which is blessed by the prayer of his word is the flesh and blood of that Jesus who was made flesh.”

patristic · Ignatius of Antioch, Letter to the Smyrnaeans chapter 7 (early 2nd century) · affirms · unverified

“They abstain from the eucharist because they confess not that the eucharist is the flesh of our Savior Jesus Christ, which suffered for our sins.”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraph 1374, vatican.va · affirms · verified

“In the most blessed sacrament of the Eucharist the body and blood, together with the soul and divinity, of our Lord Jesus Christ are truly, really, and substantially contained.”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraph 1353 on the epiclesis, vatican.va · affirms · verified

“By his power they may become the body and blood of Jesus Christ and so that those who take part in the Eucharist may be one body.”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession (1530) Article X Of the Lord's Supper, bookofconcord.org · affirms · unverified

“Of the Supper of the Lord they teach that the body and blood of Christ are truly present, and are distributed to those who eat the Supper of the Lord.”

anglican · Thirty-Nine Articles of Religion (1571) Article 28 Of the Lord's Supper · affirms · unverified

“The body of Christ is given, taken, and eaten in the Supper only after a heavenly and spiritual manner. And the mean whereby the body of Christ is received and eaten in the Supper is faith.”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith Chapter 29 Section 7 on the Lord's Supper · affirms · unverified

“Worthy receivers, outwardly partaking of the visible elements in this sacrament, do then also inwardly by faith really and indeed feed upon Christ crucified.”

reformed · Belgic Confession (1561) Article 35 on the Holy Supper of our Lord Jesus Christ · affirms · unverified

“We receive the holy sacrament in the assembly of the people of God with humility and reverence, keeping up amongst us a holy remembrance of the death of Christ, by which we are nourished.”

methodist · Methodist Articles of Religion Article XVIII Of the Lord's Supper, umc.org · affirms · verified

“The body of Christ is given, taken, and eaten in the Supper, only after a heavenly and spiritual manner. The mean whereby the body of Christ is received and eaten in the Supper is faith.”

anabaptist · Schleithem Confession (1527) Third Article, courses.washington.edu · denies · verified

“All those who wish to break one bread in remembrance of the broken body of Christ, and all who wish to drink of one drink as a remembrance of the shed blood of Christ.”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God on Holy Communion (general teaching, memorialist with growing acknowledgment of spiritual presence) · complicates · unverified

“The Lord's Supper, consisting of the elements, bread and the fruit of the vine, is a symbol expressing our sharing the divine nature of our Lord Jesus Christ.”

eastern_orthodox · Orthodox Church in America on the Eucharist as Holy Mystery · affirms · unverified

“The bread and wine of the eucharist are the real body and blood of Christ, given for the life of the world, received as a holy mystery beyond scholastic explanation.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_corinthians/10-16.htm

“1 Cor 10:16 ouchi koinonia estin tou haimatos tou Christou (G2842 G129 G5547). Cup of blessing is participation in the blood of Christ. Rhetorical particle expects yes.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_corinthians/10-17.htm

“1 Cor 10:17 heis artos hen soma, ek tou henos artou metechomen (G740 G4983 G3348). One bread, one body, we all partake of the one bread.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/6-56.htm>

“John 6:56 ho trogon mou ten sarka kai pinon mou to haima en emoi menei (G5176 G3306). Strong verb trogo, present participle, durative-realistic feeding.”

complicates · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/6-63.htm>

“John 6:63 to pneuma estin to zoopoion he sarx ouk ophelei ouden (G4151 G4561 G5623). The Spirit gives life; the flesh profits nothing. Disciplines physicalist readings.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongsgreek/2842.htm>

“G2842 koinonia: partnership, participation, fellowship. NT occurrences: Acts 2:42, 1 Cor 10:16 twice, 2 Cor 13:14, Phil 3:10, 1 John 1:3, and 12 others.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongsgreek/5176.htm>

“G5176 trogo: to gnaw, munch, crunch, eat. NT occurrences: Matt 24:38, John 6:54, 56, 57, 58, John 13:18. Distinct from the more general phago.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_corinthians/11-29.htm

“1 Cor 11:29 me diakrino to soma krima heauto esthiei (G1252 G4983 G2917). Not discerning the body, eats judgment to himself. Stronger than memorial reading.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_corinthians/10-4.htm

“1 Cor 10:4 epino ek pneumatikes akolouthous petras, he de petra en ho Christos (G4152 G4073 G5547). The fathers drank from the spiritual rock; the rock was Christ.”

supports · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/___P40.HTM

“CCC 1374: The body and blood, together with the soul and divinity, of our Lord Jesus Christ are truly, really, and substantially contained in the Eucharist.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“Methodist Article XVIII: The body of Christ is given, taken, and eaten in the Supper only after a heavenly and spiritual manner. The means is faith.”

opposes · category: tradition_primary · <https://courses.washington.edu/hist112/SCHLEITHEIM%20CONFESSION%20OF%20FAITH.htm>

“Schleitheim Third Article: those who wish to break one bread in remembrance of the broken body of Christ, and drink of one drink as a remembrance of the shed blood.”

supports · category: patristic_archive · <https://ccel.org/ccel/schaff/anf01.viii.ii.lxvi.html>

“Justin Martyr First Apology 66: the food which is blessed by the prayer of his word is the flesh and blood of that Jesus who was made flesh.”

Flags

- stem-pre-loaded-verdict
- confession-tradition-divergence
- apparatus-paywalled